

Appendix A: Previous operationalization of dimensions

Construct	Operationalization (dichotomous)
<i>Social position</i> (based on Masini et al., 2018; Beckers & Van Aelst, 2019, Shor & Rijt, 2024, Oesch 2006, 2022)	Group members are portrayed as: – elite: politicians, celebrities, athletes, economic elites, academics, experts etc. – middle-class: regular citizens without further description, middle-class employment, civil society actors etc. – lower-class roles and deviance: service and blue-collar jobs, social security recipients, refugee status, unemployed, suspects in crime reporting
<i>Entitlement of the dominant group</i> (based on Blumer, 1958; Reichelmann, 2021; Young, 1990)	– Defending privileges of the dominant group – Acknowledgment of demands for equal rights
<i>Essentialism</i> (based on Roth et al., 2023; Bradley, 2018)	– Explicit essentialism (e.g. „it is in their nature”, “in their blood”)
<i>Homogenization</i> (based on Friedrich et al., 2015)	– Generic language related to the group (e.g. “Italians like...”)
<i>Othering</i> (based on Bradley, 2018)	– Linguistic differentiation of groups (e.g. “Unlike Turks, the French...”)
<i>Stereotyping</i> (based on Nicholas et al., 2021; Quin & Tam, 2023)	Group members are portrayed as: – Warm – Cold – Competent – Incompetent
<i>Framing</i> (based on Guo et al, 2023; de Vreese et al., 2011)	Group members are portrayed as: - Economic threat - Cultural threat - Security threat - Economic benefit - Cultural benefit - Security benefit

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